Job 32 — Fundraising & Partnerships Manager

Screening Report | Human-judgement re-screen by Coco | 68 candidates assessed | Budget: PKR 150K–270K | Salary sourced from Markaz application form

1 Deep Comparative Analysis — All 68 Candidates

All 68 applications screened against JD competency framework (Donor Ecosystem, Relationship Builder, Pipeline & Deal Execution, Communication, Personal Traits). Sorted by score (highest first). Expected salary sourced from Markaz application form (canned_answers). Budget column colour-coded: green = In Budget (≤270K) · amber = Borderline (271K–350K) · red = Out of Budget (>350K). Duplicates and LinkedIn-only applications listed at end.

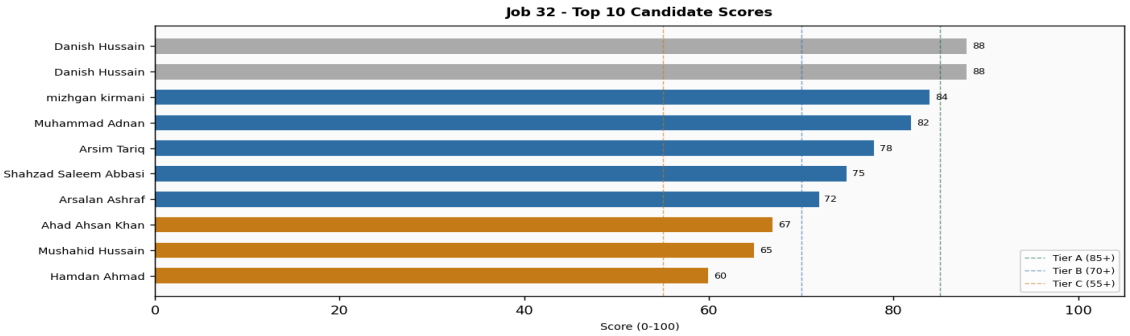
#	Candidate	Score	Tier	Budget	Exp. Salary	Experience	Background / Current Role	Key Strength / Note	Verdict
1	**Danish Hussain** App 1346	**88**	Tier A	Out of Budget	PKR 550,000	20+ yrs (rel: 15+ yrs)	Director Programs/Fundraising, multiple INGOs (Hyderabad)	STRONGEST in pool: PKR 1B+ closed (WB, ADB, FCDO, EU, UN); bilateral+multilateral; LOCATION FLAG - Hyderabad	**HOLD - Location**
2	**Danish Hussain** App 1347	**88**	Tier A	Out of Budget	PKR 550,000	20+ yrs	Duplicate - see App 1346 (Hyderabad-based)	Duplicate application; same profile; LOCATION FLAG (Hyderabad)	**DUPLICATE**
3	**mizhgan kirmani** App 1327	**84**	Tier B	In Budget	PKR 250,000	6+ yrs (rel: 4-5 yrs)	Manager Donor Relations, TCF; BD Officer, Tearfund UK (ISB)	TCF+Tearfund UK competitor signal; PKR 72.2M closed FY23-24; bilateral donor network; ISB-based	**SHORTLIST**
4	**Muhammad Adnan** App 2013	**82**	Tier B	Out of Budget	PKR 575,000	12+ yrs (rel: 6+ yrs)	Global Acquisition Mgr, C4ED (Germany); prev CERP World Bank, GIZ Pakistan, British Council (ISB)	Manages bids/proposals for WB, UN agencies, GIZ, FCDO at C4ED; CERP CLEAR Initiative (WB); GIZ TVET; ISB-based	**SHORTLIST**
5	**Arsim Tariq** App 1354	**78**	Tier B	Borderline	PKR 280K-300K	10+ yrs (rel: 8 yrs)	Resource Mobilisation & BD Consultant (ISB)	20+ multilateral projects secured (WB, UN Women, UNDP); structured pipeline management; ISB-based	**SHORTLIST**
6	**Shahzad Saleem Abbasi** App 1851	**75**	Tier B	In Budget	PKR 270,000	15+ yrs (rel: 15 yrs)	Head Fundraising, Alkhidmat Rawalpindi (ISB)	PKR 400M+/yr fundraising; 10,000+ donors; 12 CSR partnerships; Islamic philanthropy + CSR; ISB	**SHORTLIST**
7	**Arsalan Ashraf** App 1357	**72**	Tier B	Out of Budget	PKR 450,000	7+ yrs (rel: 5 yrs)	BD Manager, HANDS; prev Meta/Chevron CSR lead (Karachi, open to ISB relocation)	Closed: Meta USD 100K, Chevron USD 250K, Govt Sindh PKR 30M, START Network GBP 15K, diaspora USD 40K/month recurring; open ISB move	**SHORTLIST**
8	**Ahad Ahsan Khan** App 1722	**67**	Tier C	Out of Budget	PKR 550,000	8+ yrs (rel: 6 yrs)	Manager Grants (SRS), AKU Karachi; prev WB-HEDP Consultant ISB	AKU $134M grants portfolio; raised PKR 26.5M at NHSD NGO (UN, USAID, GGP Japan); ISB hometown; willing to relocate	**CONSIDER**
9	**Mushahid Hussain** App 1769	**65**	Tier C	In Budget	PKR 170,000	8+ yrs (rel: 3 yrs)	Donor Reporting Offr → Manager Partnerships, READ Foundation (ISB)	READ Foundation competitor signal; USD 600K 'contributed to' — supporting BD role, not independently led; ISB-based	**CONSIDER**
10	**Hamdan Ahmad** App 1381	**60**	Tier C	Borderline	PKR 320,000	5 yrs (rel: 2 yrs)	Social Safeguards Consultant, World Bank Group (ISB)	Deep WB ecosystem network; strong stakeholder communication; ISB-based; high growth potential toward donor relations	**CONSIDER**
11	**Sobia Ayub** App 2001	**58**	Tier C	Borderline	PKR 300,000	2 yrs (rel: 1 yr)	Fulbright Scholar; Masters Int'l Dev, Univ. of Pittsburgh 2025 (ISB-based)	Fulbright (top credential); 8 RFP responses at Three Rivers Youth; grant writing Capstone; strong comms & representation profile; ISB-based	**CONSIDER**
12	**Faheem Baig** App 1431	**55**	Tier C	In Budget	PKR 145,000	10+ yrs (rel: 4 yrs)	Program Manager, AKDN; prev DG-ECHO, GIZ, UN Women, USAID projects (ISB)	Strong donor ecosystem exposure (DG-ECHO, GIZ, UN Women, USAID, AKDN); program lead who fundraises — not dedicated BD role	**CONSIDER**
13	**Sarmad Iqbal** App 1958	**52**	No-Hire	Out of Budget	PKR 1,200,000	20+ yrs	B2G Partnerships Consultant (org names withheld in CV)	Claims IRC Pakistan multi-year European institutional donor deal; unverifiable — all org names and dates deliberately removed from CV	**NO-HIRE**

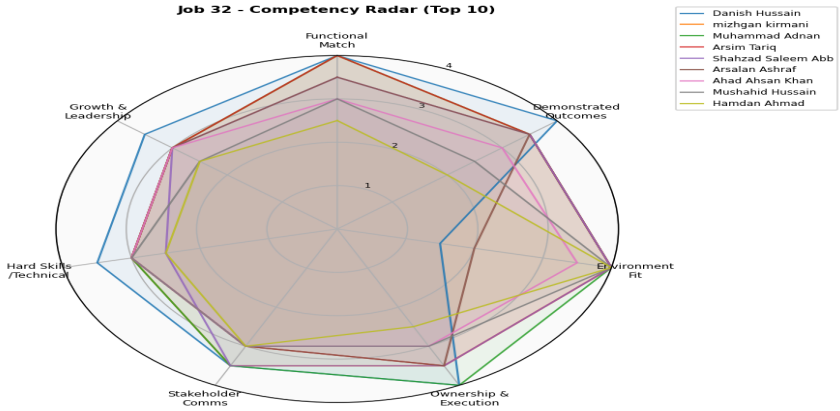
#	Candidate	Score	Tier	Budget	Exp. Salary	Experience	Background / Current Role	Key Strength / Note	Verdict
14	**sarmad iqbal** App 1959	**52**	No-Hire	Out of Budget	PKR 1,200,000	20+ yrs	Duplicate - see App 1958	Duplicate application	**DUPLICATE**
15	**Mohammad Aqeel Qureshi** App 1874	**48**	No-Hire	In Budget	PKR 180,000	20+ yrs (rel: ~2 yrs)	Manager Fundraising, Shifa Foundation (1 yr); Regional Mgr, Akhuwat (1.5 yrs)	Community-level events/zakat fundraising; 20 yrs development program implementation, not BD lead	**NO-HIRE**
16	**Muhammad Usman** App 1650	**44**	No-Hire	Borderline	PKR 350,000	18+ yrs (rel: <2 yrs)	Dy. Dir. Advancement, NUST (ISB); prev Program Mgr, Ali Trust	University advancement + nonprofit ops; broad background; no bilateral donor network or closed deals	**NO-HIRE**
17	**Sadia Sohail** App 1716	**42**	No-Hire	In Budget	PKR 140,000	7+ yrs (rel: 2 yrs)	Donor Relations Officer, READ Foundation (Rawalpindi, 2 yrs)	READ competitor signal but junior supporting role; no quantified funding amounts independently raised	**NO-HIRE**
18	**Mahnoor Mellu** App 1349	**40**	No-Hire	Borderline	PKR 350,000	5 yrs (rel: 0 yrs)	Partnerships Manager, Cloudways/DigitalOcean; Quoli.io; Educative (Lahore)	Strong SaaS/tech partnerships experience (agency partners, B2B pipeline); zero institutional donor or development sector experience	**NO-HIRE**
19	**Zubair Hussain** App 1517	**38**	No-Hire	In Budget	PKR 30,000*	13+ yrs	Program Mgr / Gender Specialist, GSF/Teach The World (ISB, Sindh work)	Development sector background; proposal writing in supporting role; no lead BD track record (*salary entry appears to be a data error)	**NO-HIRE**
20	**Shakir Manzoor Khan** App 1380	**36**	No-Hire	Borderline	PKR 350,000	15+ yrs	Head Healthcare Partnerships, Meethi Zindagi (RWP); prev Bayer HealthCare	15+ yrs pharma sales; supported grant proposals in healthcare NGO; wrong sector	**NO-HIRE**
21	**Mehboob Alam** App 1964	**36**	No-Hire	Out of Budget	USD 2,800/mo	15+ yrs	National Consultant, OCG Japan-JICA; prev Sr. Mgr Operations, AIMS Pakistan	Program management; diaspora campaigns ($50K USD+32K GBP); USD-denominated salary ~PKR 780K	**NO-HIRE**
22	**Hira Noureen Khan** App 1961	**35**	No-Hire	In Budget	PKR 250,000	17+ yrs	Manager PR & Resource Dev., Meethi Zindagi (RWP); prev Pharma Territory Mgr	Healthcare NGO fundraising; diaspora $70K raised; pharma ecosystem, not institutional donors	**NO-HIRE**
23	**Samreen Durrani** App 1875	**28**	No-Hire	In Budget	PKR 270,000	8 yrs	Content Developer Economy, MoIB (ISB); prev ops mgr, restaurant owner	LUMS MPhil Economics; operations/research background; no fundraising track record	**NO-HIRE**
24	**Sikandar Khurshid** App 1910	**25**	No-Hire	In Budget	PKR 185,000	7 yrs	Sales Manager, Shadiyana (ISB); prev Customer Success Mgr, Taleemabad	Sales/CRM in tech; former Taleemabad employee (wrong function); no donor experience	**NO-HIRE**
25	**Sani Muhammad** App 1541	**22**	No-Hire	Out of Budget	PKR 450,000	8 yrs	PM / Chief of Staff, ReBiz (US/PK tech); prev Zones LLC, Orbispay (ISB)	Tech/SaaS B2B partnerships; wrong ecosystem; no development sector or institutional donor experience	**NO-HIRE**
26	**Bilal Shahid** App 1884	**22**	No-Hire	Not Disclosed	Negotiable	3 yrs	M&A; Team Manager, Jonas Software/Contour (Lahore)	Corporate M&A; TCF volunteer fundraising only; Lahore-based; wrong sector	**NO-HIRE**
27	**Bareera Rauf** App 1317	**22**	No-Hire	Out of Budget	USD 2,000/mo	3 yrs	Founder HopeWorks; Consultant (Karachi)	Chevening Scholar, IDS Sussex; grassroots fundraising only; Karachi-based; junior; USD-denominated ~PKR 560K	**NO-HIRE**
28	**Bilal Muhammad Sajid** App 1991	**22**	No-Hire	In Budget	PKR 160,000	Intern	LUMS Student (2026 graduation); AIESEC BD; ASI intern (ISB)	Final-year undergrad; applied for wrong role (Impact & Policy); no relevant exp	**NO-HIRE**
29	**Samana Qaseem** App 1355	**22**	No-Hire	Out of Budget	PKR 430,000	Unknown	Karachi-based	Incomplete CV — Karachi-based; no relevant experience visible	**NO-HIRE**
30	**Imran Haider** App 1387	**20**	No-Hire	Borderline	PKR 350,000	Unknown	Not disclosed	Incomplete application	**NO-HIRE**

#	Candidate	Score	Tier	Budget	Exp. Salary	Experience	Background / Current Role	Key Strength / Note	Verdict
31	**Syeda Kainat** App 1424	**20**	No-Hire	In Budget	PKR 110,000	Unknown	Not disclosed	Incomplete application	**NO-HIRE**
32	**Sahrish Kashif** App 1970	**18**	No-Hire	In Budget	PKR 250,000	2 yrs	Project Manager, Karishma Ali Foundation (ISB)	Grassroots advocacy/SRHR programs; no institutional donor fundraising experience	**NO-HIRE**
33	**Hasan Shahid** App 1699	**18**	No-Hire	Out of Budget	PKR 455,000	4 yrs	Project Manager, Turing (AI/LLM) - Lahore	Media production / AI project management; SOAS Economics; no relevant fundraising	**NO-HIRE**
34	**Laveeza shah** App 1667	**18**	No-Hire	In Budget	PKR 160,000	1 yr	Digital Marketing Specialist, Pixako Technologies (ISB)	BBA grad 2024; volunteer fundraising at SOS Village only; no professional BD	**NO-HIRE**
35	**Abdul Salam** App 1356	**18**	No-Hire	Out of Budget	PKR 400,000	Unknown	Not disclosed	Incomplete application	**NO-HIRE**
36	**Muhammad Ali Zafar** App 1365	**18**	No-Hire	In Budget	PKR 100,000	Unknown	Not disclosed	Incomplete application	**NO-HIRE**
37	**AQSA GUL** App 1421	**18**	No-Hire	In Budget	PKR 70,000	Unknown	Not disclosed	Incomplete application	**NO-HIRE**
38	**Zain Ul Abideen** App 1333	**18**	No-Hire	Borderline	PKR 350,000	Unknown	Not disclosed	Incomplete application — custom answer only, no CV submitted	**NO-HIRE**
39	**Ahmed Ali** App 1334	**18**	No-Hire	Out of Budget	USD 3,500/mo	Unknown	Not disclosed	Incomplete application; Yemen-based; USD salary	**NO-HIRE**
40	**Fahad Khan** App 1335	**18**	No-Hire	Borderline	PKR 350,000	Unknown	Not disclosed	Incomplete application	**NO-HIRE**
41	**Sameen Amjad Ali** App 1337	**18**	No-Hire	Out of Budget	PKR 650,000	Unknown	Not disclosed	Incomplete application	**NO-HIRE**
42	**Anita Kanwal** App 1341	**18**	No-Hire	In Budget	PKR 200,000	Unknown	Not disclosed	Incomplete application (dup of App 1336)	**NO-HIRE**
43	**Muhammad Taqi** App 1342	**18**	No-Hire	Out of Budget	PKR 500,000	Unknown	Not disclosed	Incomplete application	**NO-HIRE**
44	**Muhammad Sumraiz Kundi** App 1344	**18**	No-Hire	In Budget	PKR 140,000	Unknown	Not disclosed	Incomplete application	**NO-HIRE**
45	**Arooj Irfan** App 1363	**15**	No-Hire	In Budget	PKR 100,000	12 yrs	Clinical Psychologist, PIMS & Max Health Hospital (ISB)	12 yrs clinical psychology; zero fundraising or development sector experience	**NO-HIRE**
46	**Ibrahim Basit** App 1963	**15**	No-Hire	In Budget	PKR 100,000	3 yrs	Management Trainee, SMASH; prev Marketing Exec, Quantum Vision (ISB/Lahore)	Marketing/content writer; no fundraising experience	**NO-HIRE**
47	**Moeen Hassan** App 1362	**15**	No-Hire	In Budget	PKR 180,000+	7 yrs	AutoCAD Engineer / Operations Mgr (Lahore)	Construction/real estate background; completely wrong profile for this role	**NO-HIRE**
48	**Bushra Nawaz** App 1957	**15**	No-Hire	In Budget	PKR 175,000	3 yrs	Business & Job Placement Officer, Islamic Relief Pakistan (Muzaffarabad)	Livelihoods/INGO field work; wrong location (Muzaffarabad); no fundraising	**NO-HIRE**
49	**Zainab** App 1580	**12**	No-Hire	In Budget	PKR 150,000	1 yr	TFP Fellow / Freelance Writer (Peshawar)	Peshawar-based fresh grad; TFP = teaching role; no fundraising	**NO-HIRE**
50	**Asim Ur Rehman** App 1702	**12**	No-Hire	In Budget	PKR 45,000	2 yrs	Social Mobilizer, Rehman Foundation (Peshawar)	Peshawar-based; Sociology fresh grad; no fundraising experience	**NO-HIRE**

#	Candidate	Score	Tier	Budget	Exp. Salary	Experience	Background / Current Role	Key Strength / Note	Verdict
51	**Tanveer Alam** App 2008	**12**	No-Hire	In Budget	PKR 145,000	4 yrs	Project Coord., GbeeTechive (Gilgit)	Gilgit-based; project coordinator / proposal support; not fundraising lead	**NO-HIRE**
52	**Muhammad Akmal** App 1542	**10**	No-Hire	In Budget	PKR 65,000	1 yr	Financial Mgmt. Trainer, Kashf Foundation (Jhang, Punjab)	Jhang-based; financial trainer; no fundraising experience	**NO-HIRE**
53	**Aymen** App 1225	**10**	No-Hire	N/A	Not Disclosed	Unknown	LinkedIn Quick Apply - no CV	No CV or info submitted	**NO-HIRE**
54	**umair** App 1332	**10**	No-Hire	N/A	Not Disclosed	Unknown	LinkedIn Quick Apply - no CV	No CV submitted	**NO-HIRE**
55	**anitakanwal** App 1336	**10**	No-Hire	N/A	Not Disclosed	Unknown	LinkedIn Quick Apply - no CV (dup 1341)	Duplicate; no CV	**NO-HIRE**
56	**mahnoor** App 1348	**10**	No-Hire	N/A	Not Disclosed	Unknown	LinkedIn Quick Apply - no CV	No CV submitted	**NO-HIRE**
57	**abeernoorbano** App 1350	**10**	No-Hire	N/A	Not Disclosed	Unknown	LinkedIn Quick Apply - no CV	No CV submitted	**NO-HIRE**
58	**tanveeralamm** App 1366	**10**	No-Hire	N/A	Not Disclosed	Unknown	LinkedIn Quick Apply - no CV	No CV submitted	**NO-HIRE**
59	**usmaanq** App 1372	**10**	No-Hire	N/A	Not Disclosed	Unknown	LinkedIn Quick Apply - no CV	No CV submitted	**NO-HIRE**
60	**imran** App 1386	**10**	No-Hire	N/A	Not Disclosed	Unknown	LinkedIn Quick Apply - no CV	No CV submitted	**NO-HIRE**
61	**AAMIR SOHAIL** App 1393	**10**	No-Hire	N/A	Not Disclosed	Unknown	CV essentially empty (40 chars)	Submitted near-empty CV twice	**NO-HIRE**
62	**saad** App 1407	**10**	No-Hire	N/A	Not Disclosed	Unknown	LinkedIn Quick Apply - no CV	No CV submitted	**NO-HIRE**
63	**AAMIR SOHAIL** App 1418	**10**	No-Hire	N/A	Not Disclosed	Unknown	LinkedIn Quick Apply - no CV (dup 1393)	Duplicate; no CV	**NO-HIRE**
64	**hassansajjadkhan** App 1515	**10**	No-Hire	N/A	Not Disclosed	Unknown	LinkedIn Quick Apply - no CV	No CV submitted	**NO-HIRE**
65	**rida** App 1889	**10**	No-Hire	N/A	Not Disclosed	Unknown	LinkedIn Quick Apply - no CV	No CV submitted	**NO-HIRE**
66	**nayab** App 1938	**10**	No-Hire	N/A	Not Disclosed	Unknown	LinkedIn Quick Apply - no CV	No CV submitted	**NO-HIRE**
67	**areebawaseempasha** App 1967	**10**	No-Hire	N/A	Not Disclosed	Unknown	LinkedIn Quick Apply - no CV	No CV submitted	**NO-HIRE**
68	**aftab** App 1972	**10**	No-Hire	N/A	Not Disclosed	Unknown	LinkedIn Quick Apply - no CV	No CV submitted	**NO-HIRE**

2 Visual Analytics — Top 10 Candidates



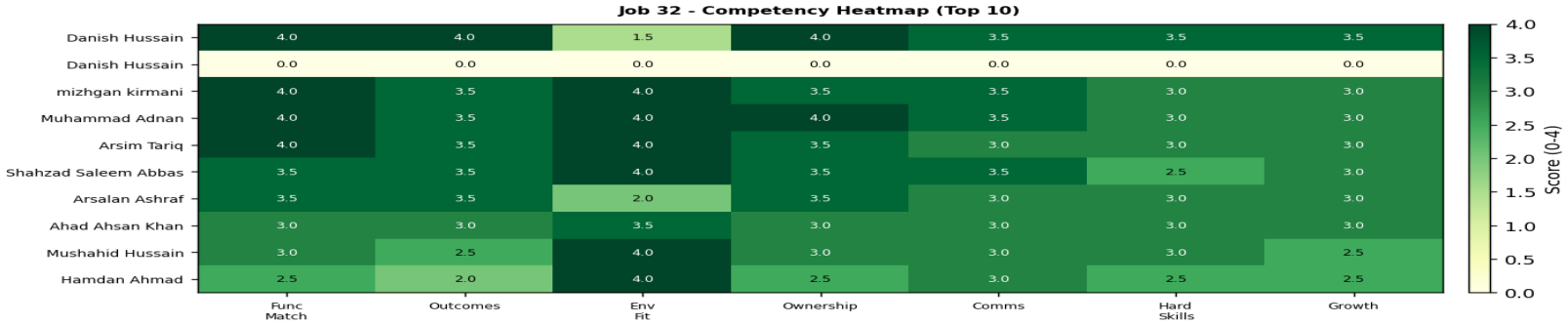


3 Strong Match — Out of Budget / Location Flag

Four strong candidates scored Tier A/B but are out of budget (salary > PKR 270K) or location-flagged. Recommend salary negotiation or relocation check before passing on these profiles.

App	Candidate	Score	Exp. Salary	Issue	Why They're Strong	Recommended Action
1346	**Danish Hussain**	**88**	PKR 550,000	OOB + Hyderabad	PKR 1B+ closed (WB, ADB, FCDO, EU, UN); 20+ yrs institutional fundraising; strongest in pool.	Confirm relocation intent first. If willing to relocate AND negotiate: priority interview.
2013	**Muhammad Adnan**	**82**	PKR 575,000	Out of Budget	Global Acquisition Mgr at C4ED — manages WB/UN/GIZ/FCDO bids; CERP World Bank CLEAR; GIZ TVET; ISB-based.	Strong donor BD profile; ISB-based. PKR 575K is 2× budget — engage on salary.
1357	**Arsalan Ashraf**	**72**	PKR 450,000	OOB + Karachi	Closed Meta USD 100K, Chevron USD 250K, Govt Sindh PKR 30M; diaspora USD 40K/month recurring.	Confirm ISB relocation. If salary negotiable and location confirmed: interview.
1722	**Ahad Ahsan Khan**	**67**	PKR 550,000	Out of Budget	AKU $134M grants portfolio; raised PKR 26.5M at NHSD NGO (UN, USAID, GGP Japan); ISB hometown; willing to relocate.	Solid grants background. Salary 2× budget. Only pursue if budget is flexible.

4 Competency Heatmap — Top 10 Candidates



5 Why Others Didn't Make the Cut

Pool Quality Warning

This was a weak pool for a senior fundraising role. Of 67 applications, only 4 Tier B candidates are genuinely ISB-based with relevant institutional donor track records. The posting attracted heavy volume from marketing professionals, IT/SaaS sales, development program managers, and fresh graduates — candidates who can pitch but have never closed institutional donor deals. Recommend re-advertising with explicit donor keywords: DFID/FCDO, World Bank, USAID, bilateral, grant pipeline.

14 LinkedIn Quick Apply / Empty CVs (Apps 1225, 1332, 1336, 1348, 1350, 1366, 1372, 1386, 1393, 1407, 1418, 1515, 1889, 1938, 1967, 1972)

No CV or near-empty placeholder submitted. Cannot assess.

Sarmad Iqbal (1958/1959) — 52 pts

Claims 20+ years and an IRC Pakistan multi-year European institutional donor deal in his cover letter. However, the CV deliberately withholds all organisation names and dates. Unverifiable. May warrant a brief screening call only if shortlisted candidates don't move forward.

Development Sector Professionals Without Fundraising Lead Role (Aqeel Qureshi 48, Muhammad Usman 44, Sadia Sohail 42, Mahnoor Mellu 40, Zubair Hussain 38, Shakir Manzoor Khan 36, Mehboob Alam 36)

Solid professional CVs — but no dedicated fundraising / BD lead role. Aqeel's 'Manager Fundraising' at Shifa Foundation was only 1 year, preceded by 20 years of program implementation. Mahnoor Mellu (Cloudways/Quoli) has strong SaaS partnerships skills but zero institutional donor or development sector experience. Sadia Sohail at READ Foundation was a junior Donor Relations Officer (2 yrs) with no independently raised amounts stated.

IT / Tech / Sales / Marketing / Adjacent Sectors (Sikandar, Sani, Bilal Shahid, Ibrahim Basit, Moeen Hassan, Hasan Shahid, Laveeza Shah, Bilal Sajid, Samreen Durrani, Sahrish Kashif, Arooj Irfan)

Candidates from SaaS, M&A;, digital marketing, clinical psychology, construction, and AI/tech backgrounds. Several wrote strong cover letters but have no institutional donor relationships, no Pakistan bilateral-donor track record, and no experience closing grants or government partnerships at scale.

Healthcare Sector Fundraisers (Hira Noureen Khan 35, Shakir Manzoor Khan 36)

Resource mobilisation experience exists but in healthcare NGOs (Type 1 diabetes programs, pharma partnerships). Meethi Zindagi's fundraising ecosystem is diaspora and pharma CSR — completely distinct from DFID/WB/USAID bilateral donor relations needed for EdTech/education sector.

Location Disqualifiers (Danish Hussain Hyderabad, Arsalan Ashraf Karachi, Mehboob Alam Peshawar, Zainab/Asim Peshawar, Bushra Nawaz Muzaffarabad, Tanveer Alam Gilgit, Zubair Hussain Sindh-work)

JD is explicit: in-office Islamabad only. Candidates not based in or credibly willing to relocate to Islamabad were not shortlisted. Danish Hussain is flagged separately as a strong profile contingent on relocation confirmation.

Fresh Graduates / Students (Bilal Sajid, Laveeza Shah, Asim Ur Rehman, Zainab, Bareera Rauf)

Year 1 target is $500K-$1M in new funding. Requires existing relationships and a proven deal-closing track record — not achievable at entry-level.

6 Next Steps

1. IN-BUDGET PRIORITY — Interview mizhgan kirmani (1327, Score 84, PKR 250K). Best ISB-based in-budget candidate: TCF + Tearfund UK competitor signal, PKR 72.2M closed FY23-24, bilateral donor network. Start here.

2. IN-BUDGET — Interview Shahzad Saleem Abbasi (1851, Score 75, PKR 270K — exactly at budget ceiling). PKR 400M+/yr at Alkhidmat; 10,000+ donors; ISB-based.

3. IN-BUDGET TIER C — Mushahid Hussain (1769, Score 65, PKR 170K) and Faheem Baig (1431, Score 55, PKR 145K). Both comfortably in budget. Mushahid: READ Foundation competitor signal. Faheem: GIZ/AKDN/DG-ECHO donor exposure.

4. SALARY NEGOTIATION — Engage Muhammad Adnan (2013, Score 82, PKR 575K). ISB-based. Manages WB/GIZ/FCDO bids at C4ED — exactly the right background. Budget gap is large (2×) but worth the conversation given the profile strength.

5. BORDERLINE — Arsim Tariq (1354, Score 78, PKR 280K-300K) is slightly above budget ceiling. Strongest multilateral pipeline experience (20+ WB/UNDP/UN Women projects). Consider if budget has any flex.

6. LOCATION + SALARY CHECK — Danish Hussain (1346, Score 88, PKR 550K, Hyderabad) is the strongest in the pool on track record. Two barriers to clear: salary and relocation. If either is resolved, interview immediately.

7. Arsalan Ashraf (1357, Score 72, PKR 450K, Karachi) — confirm ISB relocation intent AND salary negotiability before proceeding. Strong CSR closings.

8. Hamdan Ahmad (1381, 60, PKR 320K) and Sobia Ayub (2001, 58, PKR 300K) — both borderline on budget. Good profiles for consideration if Tier B interviews don't close.

9. Pool warning: Of 68 applications, only 2–3 candidates are genuinely qualified AND in-budget. Re-post with explicit salary range visible and stronger donor keywords (FCDO/DFID, World Bank, USAID, bilateral) to attract the right experience level.